

LIVE



NEWSPAPER 21st November, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

47th WEEK



GERMANY AND CONSENSUS

UPSC CSE – GS II

**GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF
DEVELOPED NATIONS ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.**



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

21st NOVEMBER, 2017

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Falling apart

As talks on a coalition fail in Germany, Angela Merkel faces her career's biggest challenge

The crisis over government formation in Berlin has raised the possibility of fresh elections in Germany and the ripple effect of instability in the European Union. The breakdown in talks between Chancellor Angela Merkel's Christian Democratic Union and potential partners to get the requisite numbers in the Reichstag has dealt a blow to a time-tested post-War model of political compromise and consensus-building. A major sticking point in the coalition negotiations among the three ideologically disparate parties – the centre-right CDU, the left-wing Greens and the pro-market Free Democratic Party – was whether the hundreds of thousands of Syrian refugees who migrated to Germany should be allowed to bring their families. Curiously, the CDU conceded the extension of the current freeze on family reunion, on the insistence of its sister party, the Christian Social Union. This is a substantial concession from a party that backed the government's bold decision to open the doors in 2015 to rescue millions who had risked their lives to reach Europe. The Greens, key allies in a potential Jamaica coalition with the conservatives and the FDP, fell in line, despite their humanitarian stance on refugees. But the FDP dug in its heels, demanding the phasing out of a tax to support Germany's eastern regions. Remarks by its leader that it is better not to govern than govern badly is a measure of the discord during the negotiations.

In this fluid scenario, another general election cannot be ruled out, especially as the centre-left Social Democratic Party has so far foreclosed the possibility of cohabiting with the conservatives in another grand coalition. After it received its worst-ever drubbing in the September elections, the party may be reluctant to revisit its position, lest it risk further erosion of its popular base. But in the unlikely event of it backing the CDU, the Social Democrats may insist on offering support to a candidate other than Ms. Merkel as Chancellor. A minority government led by the CDU is a theoretical possibility, but even the conservatives do not seem to warm up to it. That leaves the President with the responsibility of determining whether fresh elections are the only option. The far right Alternative for Germany, which emerged as the third largest party in the elections, believes it can further consolidate those unprecedented gains – something the mainstream parties will be conscious of during last-ditch attempts to cobble together a coalition. The proof of the efficacy of the German consensus model lay in solidifying the political centre-ground over the decades. The need for a strong middle ground could not be greater than it is at this point. Once the Netherlands and France averted political instability at the hands of populist and eurosceptic parties earlier this year, the outcome in Germany had appeared to be a foregone conclusion. Perhaps not.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date : 21st November, 2017

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North
Atlantic
Ocean

North Sea

GERMANY

GERMANY

BELARUS

POLAND

UKRAINE

CZECH REP

SLOVAKIA

AUSTRIA

HUNGARY

FRANCE

SWITZERLAND

ROMANIA

CROATIA

Bosnia
and
Herzegovina

SERBIA

BULGARIA

Black Sea

ITALY

Adriatic Sea

Greece

Aegean Sea

TURKEY

Ionian Sea

SPAIN

Balearic Sea

PORTUGAL

Alboran Sea

Chancellor Angela Merkel won for the 4th term in Germany's election.

PREVIOUS NEWS REPORT



Angela Merkel
German Chancellor

SALIENT POINTS

- However, there is a rise of the alternative German party (AfD), which not only became the 1st far-right wing to enter German Parliament since world war II and in this process, it became the 3rd largest party.
- It also shows that there is substantial anger at Merkel's Government opening the borders to one million asylum seekers.
- Angela Merkel's Christian Democratic Union has got 33% vote share and emerged as the single largest party in German elections.
- The social democrats (SPD) is the 2nd largest party with 20.5%.

**ANGELA MERKEL**

Chancellor of Germany

**Freie
Demokraten****FDP**

NEWS REPORT

- There is crisis over the Government formation.
- It is a blow to the time tested post war model of political compromise.
- This is with regard to hundreds of thousands of Syrian refugees should be allowed to bring their families or not.
- Angela Merkel was forced to seek an alliance with unlikely group of parties after September elections left her without a majority.
- Ms.Merkel is in power for 12 years.
- The parties also differ on environmental issues, where FDP emphasise the need to protect industry and jobs.



ANGELA MERKEL
Chancellor of Germany

WHAT DOES THIS INDICATE?

- 1 The President has to determine whether the fresh elections is the only option or not.
- 2 In that case, the far right alternative for Germany, which emerged as third largest party in the elections may consolidate further gains.
- 3 The Main stay of German politics is consensus for several decades and the proof of this model lay in solidifying the political centre-ground.

Hence there is a need for strong middle ground.

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

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